

Hang on to your 'hats,' folks

By CAM COLE
Journal Staff Writer

They were gone, dead, buried. Down two goals in the other team's building and all ready to drown in a Red Sea.

The Edmonton Oilers should have recognized all those certainties — maybe, deep in their hearts, they almost did.

But an innocent little shot from the left-wing boards by rookie Esa Tikkanen somehow found its way past Calgary Flames goalie Mike Vernon, and suddenly the champs were breathing again.

Flames party ruined E1

Leads with 5-3 E2

Suddenly, first-goal wins didn't HAVE to be true. Hat-Trick Fever lives.

That Tikkanen goal, the first sign of mortality from Vernon in quite a while, was the wedge the Oilers needed to force their way back into the game that could have — perhaps should have — ended their quest for a third straight Stanley Cup.

It gave them the will to dig deeper, to find a championship effort left inside them, and they didn't stop digging until it was 5-2.

"Just when things seem to be at their worst, you bounce back. That's what great teams do," Lee Fogelin said prophetically, after Mark Messier's shorthanded, breakaway goal had tied it 2-2.

"The guys were sky-high before the game," Fogelin said, "and they knew close wasn't good enough. That big goal by Messier seemed to turn things around for us."

So the series is even at 3-3, and the Battle of Alberta is a best-of-five series, Wednesday night at Northlands Coliseum, where you'd better hang on to your hats.

Throughout the series, the first goal had been crucial — only Edmonton's overtime win in Game Two had gone against the flow. But this time, the Oilers had to fight off goals 22 seconds apart by Joey Mullen and John Tonelli.

The Oilers threw away a written invitation to take control early in the third period when Messier saw an open net and fired Jani Kurri's rebound high and wide.

But then came The Goal — an absolute Oiler goal, full of windburn, big names and fancy passing. Paul Coffey swooped in on the left side, Wayne Gretzky somehow found him with the puck, and Coffey laid a perfect pass in the slot to Glenn Anderson, who rifled it between Vernon's legs.

Scalpers said they were getting \$500 for seats in the Saddledome, as Calgaryans were primed to celebrate their own Stanley Cup in April, but the Oilers wouldn't cooperate.

Behind another brilliant night in the net by goalie Grant Fuhr, they checked the Flames relentlessly after the Anderson goal.

If the Oilers can remember as far back as Sunday, however, they should know the series is far from over. The Flames' only playoff loss at Northlands this spring has come in overtime.

And Edmonton might not be able to stand another one of those.

Oilers 5

Flames 2



The Edmonton Journal

25 Cents (Metro only) TUESDAY, APRIL 29, 1986

\$108M shot for oil sands from Getty

By Journal Staff Writers

Premier Don Getty revealed \$108 million in aid Monday for Syncrude and Suncor but denied his government is bailing out the troubled oil sands giants.

He also announced a new heart-transplant program for Edmonton but denied the timing has anything to do with the May 8 election.

• Syncrude gets an interest-free \$85-million loan to fund engineering and planning work on its proposed \$4.5-billion expansion.

Business reacts A8
Heart-lung program; election coverage D1
Suncor strikes D4

• Suncor's provincial royalties are slashed from 12 per cent to one per cent, from April 1 to Dec. 31, 1986. The move will cost taxpayers \$23 million.

• University Hospital gets \$1.7 million to do 12 heart-lung transplants a year, along with \$900,000 to establish the new program.

Although the announcements came only 10 days before the election, Getty denied opposition charges they're election goodies.

Government responsibilities continue whether there is an election or not, he told reporters.

The announcements were made Monday because cabinet approved the initiatives earlier in the day, Getty said.

New Democrat Leader Ray Martin described the energy announcements as little more than electioneering. He did, however, commend the move to establish a transplant program.

Getty said Alberta will pay for the Syncrude expansion's engineering and basic planning to ensure the project isn't delayed by low oil prices.

"The Syncrude owners have agreed to repay us from the proceeds of the expansion when the final construction is completed. The \$85 million will be a loan investment from the heritage trust fund."

However, Syncrude hasn't guaranteed construction will go ahead when the planning is completed late in 1986, Getty acknowledged.

And Alberta won't get its money back if the expansion is abandoned.

Representative Party Leader Ray Specker was pleased with the announcements, noting that his party was urging a reduction in royalties for Suncor.

But Specker also called the moves "just another additional election announcement by the Tory party to gain power again."

Getty denied Suncor is considering a plant closure, although company officials said last week the plant could shut down if oil prices stay depressed long enough. He has not asked for assurances that the Suncor plant will stay open if royalties are cut.

Alberta had to act without help from the federal government, he said.

Weather

Occasional rain mixed with snow. Highs near 5. Chance of rain 90 per cent. Wednesday showers. D7

AUTO GUIDE

The cars that will put some zip in your spring. Inside.



April is Cancer Month

Lotto Luck
52 weeks of 6/49 numbers — E8

OUR OPINION: The real danger of terrorism is not violence itself but the hysteria and overreaction we allow it to create in our society. A6

FLAIR: Sun-ian weather will soon be here and we have the summer to fit the season. C1

Scratch for Cash

Today's numbers — B2

Am-Lesley	C7	Mary Norton	E1
Bergs	E8	Nicholas Lee	C5
Bell	C6	Don Dymally	A4
Bridge	D9	Shirley Ann	C8
Burns	A2	Frank Miller	E2
Canada	A202	Spinks	E1-6
City	B1-3	Stokes	A10
Combs	D10	Talbot	E7
Connelly	D8	Wheeler	D7
Costa	A4	Woods	D7
Don Brad	A7	Your Opinion	A2-A
Dunlop	A2		
Dr. Demme	C8		
Eaton	B5		
Entertainment	E4-6	Order form	D10
Fair	C1-6	Employment	D2D2
Fleming	A12	Land	
Forrester	D6	Mini Market	D7
Gunn	E2	Nelson	D10
Lemay	C7-8	Verities	D6-12
Lotto Luck	E8	West	E4-6

HERMAN



Alcoholism put engineer in hospital

By KIM McLEOD
Journal Staff Writer

The engineer of the freight train involved in the Hinton disaster went on a drinking binge before being admitted to hospital last summer, an inquiry heard Monday.

The testimony, which came from a surgeon who treated Jack Hudson, contradicted statements by a Canadian National Railways witness, who told the inquiry last week that Hudson stopped drinking in January 1985.

Dr. Geoffrey Pretty, CNR regional medical officer, had said the company's district medical officer in Jasper told him that Hudson, 48, gave up drinking after being admitted to an alcohol rehabilitation centre in January 1985.

When admitted to the Royal Alexandra General Hospital in July 1985, Hudson was close to death, suffering from acute pancreatitis — an inflammation of the pancreas — Dr. Brian Johnson told to control the condition by following a proper diet.

Johnson said Hudson's recovery was "excellent" and there was no need for drugs to prevent alcohol withdrawal symptoms.

Under questioning by James Scott, lawyer for the Brotherhood of Locomotive Engineers, Johnson agreed that blurred vision can be a "byproduct" of high blood pressure and diabetes.

CN medical records show Hudson had high blood pressure as early as 1980.

The inquiry has also heard the freight passed by signals set to stop the train before it collided with an oncoming passenger train.

Pretty told the inquiry that tests done two weeks before the crash, which would indicate recent traces of alcohol, showed Hudson had not been drinking.

Hudson was the engineer of the freight train that collided with a Via Rail passenger train Feb. 8 near Hinton, killing 23 people.

Wayne Smith, conductor of the freight train, told the inquiry he lost radio contact with Hudson minutes before the crash.

CN employees investigating the cause of the crash tested Smith's radio several times and could not find any major problems, a witness said Monday.

When Hudson left the hospital, he was diagnosed as a diabetic and told to control the condition by following a proper diet.

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Deaths feared after Soviet nuclear accident

MOSCOW (AP) — A nuclear accident damaged an atomic reactor at the Chernobyl power plant in the Ukraine, the Soviet Union said Monday.

Radiation swept across Finland, Denmark and Sweden, more than 1,200 km away.

A U.S. state department official said there probably were deaths because the radiation travelled so far.

The official news agency, Tass, said people affected were being aided, but did not say whether there were injuries or deaths, when the accident occurred, nor the exact location of the plant.

However, government-run Hungarian radio reported early today that people were injured in the accident near Kiev.

"There are injuries... The injured are being medically treated," said the broadcast on Budapest Radio. "Steps are being taken to eliminate the consequences of the accident."

Tass said it was the first nuclear accident in the Soviet Union and a government commission was appointed, an indication that it was serious.

Lars Erik de Geer of Sweden's Defence Research Agency said: "It must have been a relatively big accident, since we have received such high levels of radiation from so far away."

He said the radiation levels corresponded to those recorded after

nuclear weapons' tests in the atmosphere during the 1970s. "I know of no earlier nuclear power plant accident which has led to such high radiation levels in this area," he said.

Picture A3

No fallout from the accident has been detected in Canada, said Ernest Letourneau, head of the federal government's Bureau of Radiation and Medical Devices.

But the bureau, which tests for radiation in the air at weather stations across the country, is taking daily samples just in case, Letourneau said.

"It would be very surprising if anything turned up," he said.

The Budapest Radio report noted Chernobyl is located at the junction of two rivers, Pripyat and Uzh, "where the

Kiev water reservoir on the Dnieper (River) begins."

It made no other reference to the water supply for Kiev, a city of 2.4 million.

Finland reported picking up increased radiation Sunday night, but neither it nor Sweden said the levels were dangerous.

Edmonton's Ukrainian Canadians with relatives in the Soviet Union will probably have to depend on letters to find out if loved ones are safe, said Yar Slavutych, a retired University of Alberta professor.

Slavutych's mother and sister live about 500 km south of Kiev in a small village and do not have a telephone. He will send a letter to them today but it will take three weeks to arrive.

"I am definitely worried... It's a terrible thing," said Slavutych, who was in Chernobyl in 1941.

